

「1 級リスニングテスト」 原稿

ただいまから、1 級リスニングテストを行います。これからお話しすることについて質問は受けませんので、よく注意して聞いてください。このテストでは、テストの方法と注意事項がすべて英語で放送されます。

The listening test for the Grade 1 examination is about to begin. Listen carefully to the directions. You will not be permitted to ask questions during the test.

This test has four parts. All of the questions in these four parts are multiple-choice questions. For each question, choose the best answer from among the four choices written in your test booklet. On your answer sheet, find the number of the question and mark your answer. You are permitted to take notes for every part of this listening test.

Now, here are the directions for **Part 1**. In this part, you will hear 10 dialogues, **No. 1** through **No. 10**. Each dialogue will be followed by one question. For each question, you will have 10 seconds to choose the best answer and mark your answer on your answer sheet. The dialogue and the question will be given only once. Now, let's begin.

(★=男性 A ★★=男性 B ☆=女性 A ☆☆=女性 B)

★No. 1

☆☆: Clark, I think it's time to consider a nursing home for your mother.

★★: Yeah, I was afraid you were going to suggest that.

☆☆: We simply can't give her the care she needs anymore.

★★: I know, Margaret. It's just that it'll be hard not to have her here with us.

☆☆: Look, I have a few printouts from local nursing homes I found online. They aren't cheap, but I think we might be able to find a suitable one near our place.

★★: All right. Let's take a look.

★Question: How does the man feel about the woman's suggestion?

★★No. 2

★: So, what do you think of the office space, Ms. Kato?

☆: The location is outstanding, but it's quite a bit more spacious than what we were originally looking for.

★: I understand that, but given the way your firm has been expanding over the past two years, it might make sense to allow yourself some flexibility.

☆: Good point. On a square-meter basis the price is certainly reasonable. And I'd hate to have to think about relocating again, at least not for several years.

★★Question: What will the woman probably do?

☆☆No. 3

★★: What do you think about the big bribery case? Do you think the senator will plead guilty?

☆: With all the evidence against him, he'd be a fool not to.

★★: I don't know. I'd be surprised if he confesses.

☆: But the odds are so stacked against him. The media exposed everything.

★★: Yeah, but white-collar crime is complex. It's hard to pin down blame.

☆: You don't think he'll get off, do you?

★★: He's got a huge team of lawyers. If he does decide to fight the charges, who knows

what'll happen?

☆☆**Question:** What does the woman think about the accused?

☆**No. 4**

★: I.T. Group, Bill Friedman speaking.

☆☆: Bill, this is Gloria Bailey in marketing. I was told two weeks ago that I needed to change my password, but to be honest it slipped my mind. Now I can't access the network.

★: OK, Gloria. I'll have to ask you to come over here so that I can verify your company ID and have you fill out a form.

☆☆: I see. I've got a meeting in a few minutes. Would one o'clock this afternoon be all right?

★: That's fine. See you then.

☆**Question:** What problem does the woman have?

★**No. 5**

★★: Do you know when class registration begins, Tina?

☆☆: Online registration starts alphabetically on Monday. Unfortunately, with our surnames, we'll be nearly the last to register.

★★: Meaning the pickings are likely to be pretty slim, then.

☆☆: Don't worry, Alex. If the classes you want are full, I was told you should speak to the professor directly.

★★: Are you sure that'll make any difference?

☆☆: My advisor said the professor would accept more students than the limit, if the course is a prerequisite for completion of the degree.

★★: Well, that's a relief to know that.

★**Question:** What does the woman imply?

★★**No. 6**

☆: Mark, I think it's time to fix that dent in the rear bumper.

★: But, honey, it's not even that noticeable.

☆: It looks awful! Anyway, our insurance will pay for the repairs.

★: True, but then our insurance premiums will go up.

☆: How do you know that?

★: That's what the company told me when I called to ask about it. I was responsible for the damage, remember? I backed into that parked car.

☆: Oh, that's right.

★★**Question:** Why is the man reluctant to fix the car?

☆☆**No. 7**

★★: How are things working out with your new job?

☆: Not so well. It's a full-time position, but I just learned that contract workers from outside get paid more than I do for the same work.

★★: That doesn't sound right. What are you going to do?

☆: I've only been working there for a few weeks, so I'll just hold off for now and bring it up with personnel when the time is right.

★★: Well, I hope things work out.

☆: Me, too.

☆☆**Question:** What is the woman planning to do?

☆**No. 8**

☆☆: Jake! I haven't seen you for ages. How've you been?

★: Good, thanks, Harriett. I got hitched a couple of years back, and my wife had a baby last year.

☆☆: That's wonderful. I bet it's turned your life upside down a bit, too.

★: No kidding. My life seems like an endless series of diaper changes and nighttime feedings.

☆☆: I remember how tough that can be. Are you a stay-at-home dad, then?

★: Yes. My wife's got a high-powered job, so it makes more sense this way, but it's wiping me out.

☆**Question:** What do we learn from the conversation?

★**No. 9**

★★: What are you making for dinner, honey?

☆: Vegetable soup and whole-wheat bread rolls. I can put a salad together, too, if you want.

★★: You're really serious about this new diet, aren't you? All we've eaten is fruit and vegetables for the last week now.

☆: That's an exaggeration. We had some bacon with breakfast the other day and a tuna sandwich for lunch today. Anyway, your doctor's been saying that your cholesterol's way too high. Just hang in there, and let's see what happens.

★★: But I'm dying for a hamburger with french fries and a sundae. Cheating now and then can't hurt that much!

☆: Why don't you look at the book where I got the diet from? I think it would change your attitude. And I feel much better after just one week.

★★: Well, you were never much into meat and cheese anyway. But my stomach's been growling, and I feel so lethargic. I think we've gone overboard.

☆: I'm sure you'll adjust. My friend Kathleen's a vegetarian, and she has lots of energy.

★★: Good for her, but there's no way I'm going to become a vegetarian.

☆: No one's expecting you to. It's just a matter of balance, like the book says. You've consumed too many meat and dairy products for way too long.

★**Question:** What do we learn from this conversation?

★★**No. 10**

☆: Listen, I think we have to review our business strategy for the new line of DVD players.

☆☆: Why? Sales are up 15 percent this quarter. I'm very proud of what our sales staff have achieved.

☆: You say that, Pauline, but actually demand is extremely strong at the moment. The rumors are that most of our rivals have improved their figures even more. What do you think, David?

★: The problem is our advertising budget. It's way too small.

☆: I disagree. Surveys show that consumers are fully aware of our name. I think the problem is that our players are not there in the shops even if people want them. I spent last Sunday going around the stores downtown, and five of them didn't have a single one of our players in stock.

☆☆: I'm shocked to hear that. I'll get my people on it right away. The trouble is that stores won't stock goods unless they think they'll sell.

★: That brings us back to the problem of image. We have to get ourselves talked about if we want people to buy our goods.

☆: I'm not saying that advertising is unimportant, but it's very expensive. Our first goal should be to get the goods on the shelves.

☆☆: Well, I'll talk to the sales staff again, but don't expect any miracles.

★★**Question:** What does the man suggest they do?

Here are the directions for **Part 2**. In this part, you will hear five passages, (A) through (E). Each passage will be followed by two questions, **No. 11** through **No. 20**. For each question, you will have 10 seconds to choose the best answer and mark your answer on your answer sheet. The passage and the questions will be given only once. Now, let's begin.

☆☆(A) *Clearing the Air*

Some recent studies indicate that many people assume the air quality inside buildings is equivalent to, or even surpasses, that outside. Not so, says the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency. The EPA's study indicated that air pollution levels indoors may be five times worse than outdoors. The harmful effects can include headaches, irritation of the eyes, throat, and skin, as well as dizziness. While poor air quality does affect homes, the EPA says it is actually a more pressing issue in commercial buildings, where people spend their working lives.

Some pollutants detected in buildings originate from outside, but many are actually released indoors. Sources such as mold, building materials, office equipment, and carpets give off dangerous, toxic gases. Ironically, cleaning products designed to protect us from dirt and bacteria can also contribute to the problem as they contain hazardous chemicals. Some companies have responded by boosting ventilation through the installation of air intakes, fans, and filters. Experts also believe that allowing newly made materials to release their gases at manufacturing plants for a few months, before shipping and installing them, would also have a positive impact on indoor air quality.

★Questions

★**No. 11** What does the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency study indicate?

★**No. 12** What is one thing some companies are doing?

★★(B) *Seeds of Survival*

In prehistoric times, the black palm tree, which is found in modern-day Panama, had a symbiotic relationship with an enormous elephant-like creature called the gomphothere. Gomphotheres had a huge appetite for the fruit and were able to reach up into the tree's canopy to obtain it. After the fruit was swallowed whole, the large seed within it would slowly pass through the animal's body and be dropped in a new location, allowing it to germinate there.

However, the gomphothere became extinct thousands of years ago. In such cases, it is not unusual for the other partner in a symbiotic relationship also to perish. The black palm, however, had a savior in a rodent known as the agouti. The demise of the gomphothere allowed these diminutive animals to collect and bury black palm fruit as a backup food source for when times are tough. Scientists recently discovered that agoutis provide an efficient mechanism for dispersing black palm tree seeds as they often make off with food that belongs to other agoutis. Because agoutis often do not need to eat the fruit, the seed inside may be carried innumerable times, enabling it to travel great distances.

☆Questions

- ☆No. 13 Why was the black palm tree in danger of disappearing?
☆No. 14 What is one thing scientists have learned about agoutis?

☆(C) *The Science of Forgiveness*

Many religious and spiritual traditions promote the virtue of forgiveness. As a student at Stanford University, Fred Luskin became interested in discovering whether there really were any inherent merits to forgiving, and if so, whether these could be measured. Luskin developed a forgiveness training program, which he tested on a group of volunteers, each of whom had been wronged in some way. After the program, Luskin said the volunteers showed an appreciable reduction in their anger levels. In a wider study, Luskin demonstrated that his training also significantly reduced stress-related symptoms such as chest pain and migraines. He then established the Stanford Forgiveness Project, a program to improve people's psychological and physical well-being through forgiving those who have wronged them.

The emphasis of the training program is on people letting go of their anger and accepting the hurt they or their families have suffered. Luskin's training has also proved effective with victims of conflict. It has been used with individuals in Northern Ireland, for example, whose family members were killed in violence between Protestants and Catholics. Although the training does not deal with the root causes of conflict or violence, Luskin believes forgiveness training can at least help some people move forward.

★★Questions

- ★★No. 15 What is one thing Fred Luskin attempted to do while he was a student?
★★No. 16 How has Luskin's training program been used?

★(D) *Brainpower*

Most laypeople assume that when human brain cells die, they are gone forever. In the past decade, however, neurologists have determined that brain-cell regeneration, or neurogenesis, does occur. What's more, preliminary studies on rats suggest there may be a positive correlation between the ability to deal with cognitive challenges and brain-cell regeneration. By further analyzing how neurogenesis happens, neurologists hope to unlock ways to regenerate cells in people who have suffered brain injuries or have brain disorders.

Psychologists such as Margie Lachman are also interested in understanding why brainpower declines faster in some people than others. Lachman suggests that education is an essential element of mental health. A large study in the U.S. has highlighted that people who have attained a higher level of education tend to experience a slower decline in memory. Participants in their early 70s with college educations performed memory and recognition tasks as well as people 10 years younger who had no higher education. Other studies suggest that so-called crystallized intelligence, which is the ability to use skills and experience, can actually get better with time. Research into neurogenesis and declining brainpower is still in its infancy, but some researchers believe that specific techniques to mitigate the effects of brain degeneration may be on the horizon.

☆☆Questions

- ☆☆No. 17 What have neurologists discovered?
☆☆No. 18 What did the large study in the U.S. reveal?

☆☆(E) *Focus on Food*

Every year, approximately 48 million Americans are affected by food-borne illnesses. This costs \$35 billion in related medical treatments and lost productivity annually. As

consumers grow ever more concerned about where their food comes from and whether it is safe, they demand more accountability from those who produce and distribute it. A big obstacle to achieving this, however, is identifying exactly where in the supply chain a problem occurred. To address this, a nationwide tracking system that utilizes barcode labels is being created. The system's designers believe that using barcode data could help pinpoint every place a particular product was handled, from farm to store, within two days of a food-poisoning case being reported.

Since startup costs for this high-tech system are so prohibitive, involvement will initially be voluntary. Consumer groups, however, are up in arms, and they are demanding that food producers and distributors be required to participate. These groups say mandatory tracking would not only help contain food-borne illnesses, it would also encourage businesses to create more transparent and hygienic production and distribution networks to provide the public with safe food products.

★★Questions

★★No. 19 Why is the new system being introduced?

★★No. 20 Why are consumer groups concerned?

Here are the directions for **Part 3**. In this part, you will hear five passages, (F) through (J). The passages represent real-life situations and may contain sound effects. Each passage will have one question, **No. 21** through **No. 25**. Before each passage, you will have 10 seconds to read the situation and question written in your test booklet. After you hear the passage, you will have 10 seconds to choose the best answer and mark your answer on your answer sheet. The passage will be given only once. Now, let's begin.

☆ (F) You have 10 seconds to read the situation and Question No. 21.

★Swelling and bruising are normal, so that's not a cause for concern. If there were a bone fracture, you'd be experiencing more pain, so we can forget about an x-ray. It looks like a small hematoma—that's a pool of blood within the damaged tissue—has formed. It doesn't pose any real danger, but having it drained would speed up your recovery. I'm glad you haven't had a fever as that would have meant the cut had become infected and that would have required treatment with antibiotics. OK, remember to ice your leg several times a day for 20 minutes at a time. Keep it elevated as much as possible to reduce swelling. And rest as much as possible. If the pain gets worse, let me know, and I'll write a prescription for painkillers.

☆ Now mark your answer on your answer sheet.

★★ (G) You have 10 seconds to read the situation and Question No. 22.

☆Welcome to this exhibition featuring installation artist Sharon Sullivan. Ms. Sullivan is particular about unauthorized images of her work being distributed, so photography is restricted. Members of the press and other mass-media professionals must have applied in advance for permission to take and publish photos. Those who have done so can pick up their photography permits from me in just a moment. Members of the general public are permitted to take photos for personal use. This means that you can show them to family and friends but cannot sell, reproduce, or display the photos on websites, blogs, and so on. You'll have to sign an agreement to that effect first. I have the press photo permits, and the agreements are at the desk next to the reception. Finally, flash photography is not permitted. Thank you, and enjoy the exhibition.

★★ Now mark your answer on your answer sheet.

☆☆(H) You have 10 seconds to read the situation and Question No. 23.

★★Basically, you can rent, lease, or buy. Car-rental companies generally offer reasonable deals, and most of them charge by the week. The big advantage is that you don't have to worry about maintenance. You'd end up paying at least \$300 per month. Leasing is another alternative. That's like a long-term rental that gives you the option to buy the car at the end. A minimum lease agreement is usually 24 months. Leasing a 3-door hatchback would cost about \$200 a month, but over two years, that's \$4,800. You could also buy a car outright. A decent used car costs around \$3,000, so you could pay it off in a year with monthly installments of \$250. You could also finance a small new car for about the same rate. However, that would take 48 months or so to pay off.

☆☆Now mark your answer on your answer sheet.

★ (I) You have 10 seconds to read the situation and Question No. 24.

☆☆Thanks for agreeing to teach the course. Your expertise will benefit our students greatly. We've already contacted your home institution to reassure them the change won't hinder your research. Now, since your visa doesn't allow you to teach, we'll have to send you back to immigration to obtain the necessary permission. It's a fairly straightforward process, though, and usually only takes a couple of weeks. Once approved, you'll receive a passport stamp that will allow you to engage in activities outside the parameters of your visa. Of course, as the institution requesting this change, we'll need to provide a letter of support that outlines the reasons we need you. I can get that to you tomorrow. You'll then need to submit that in person along with your application. If approval doesn't come by the time classes begin, we'll arrange for another faculty member to fill in temporarily.

★Now mark your answer on your answer sheet.

☆ (J) You have 10 seconds to read the situation and Question No. 25.

★Yours is nonrefundable, so you usually have only 24 hours following your booking in which to make changes at no additional charge. At this point, any changes normally require an administrative fee of \$150, and you would also be responsible for any fare differences. However, we have just started a trial campaign offering business-class passengers more flexibility on their return flights. If you wait until after your departure to change the return date, you will only be required to pay any fare difference, but you will not be liable for the administrative fee. Although it's too late this time, we recommend that you upgrade your frequent-flyer membership in the future, as all administrative fees for flight changes are waived, and many other benefits are also available.

☆☆Now mark your answer on your answer sheet.

Finally, here are the directions for **Part 4**. In this part, you will hear an interview. The interview will be followed by two questions, **No. 26** and **No. 27**. For each question, you will have 10 seconds to choose the best answer and mark your answer on your answer sheet. The interview and the questions will be given only once.

★★Now let's listen to the interview. This is an interview with Peter Winters, who works for a glass-engraving company.

Interviewer (I): So, Peter. Tell us a little bit about what your company produces.

Peter Winters (PW): Most of the things that we make are replicas engraved inside glass, of buildings or anime characters, sports memorabilia, and things like that.

I: I see. What does your job involve?

PW: I am involved in all of the steps that it takes to get a design from idea to engraved in the glass.

I: What have you learned through working at your company?

PW: I've learned in particular just how complicated it is to make things. When you're in a shop and you see trinkets that just look cheap and—I guess I've learned that it's a lot more complicated than I thought it was. You can look at things and think that they look cheap, but you don't realize just how many stages there were to production.

I: Mm-hmm. What aspects of your job do you find the most rewarding?

PW: I'm particularly fond of the start-and-finish aspect of my job, that every, every different thing we make is, I, I look at as a different project. And, so, while some of them last quite a long time, months, and some of them can go much faster, I like that we start something and we finish something and then we move on to the next thing.

I: So, Peter, I hear your background is actually in urban planning. Can you tell us a little bit about what that is?

PW: It deals essentially with how humans use space. And so where they go, what's needed, what services are needed and, if, for example, there's an open space, how will people who live nearby use it.

I: I believe you've been involved in projects to set up what you call "productive spaces." Could you explain what those are?

PW: Well, first let me tell you why, what I defined as a productive space. Instead of the narrow idea of, of agricultural space, I broadened it to include community farms and, and anything that produces food. So any green space within an urban area that is used to produce food, and that could be professionally or by amateurs.

I: Mm-hmm. How can productive spaces benefit local communities?

PW: Well, in terms of direct benefit, if there is a community farm, or a place where someone can use green space to grow their own food, of course there's a direct benefit in not only the experience, but of course the food that they can get from that. But even people who aren't involved in, if, in productive land that's near, nearby, if your neighbor is growing cabbage, for example, then you still have the open space, so you have the sunlight, and you might have a breeze nearby. So it, it has a, a broad benefit, not only just the food, from production, but also the, the green space.

I: Thank you so much for being with us today, Peter.

PW: My pleasure.

★★Questions

★★No. 26 What does Peter say about working for the glass company?

★★No. 27 What does Peter say about productive spaces?

Your time is up. Stop writing and wait quietly until the answer sheets have been collected.

では、時間です。筆記用具を置いて答えの記入をやめてください。試験監督者に連絡いたします。これより最終の受験者数を確認してください。その後、解答用紙を回収し枚数の確認を行ってください。受験者数と解答用紙の枚数の一致を確認してから、解散の指示を出してください。受験者の皆さんは、身のまわりをよく点検し、忘れものがないように注意してください。受験者の皆さんが退出するときは、別の教室が試験中の場合もありますので、声を出さず、校舎出口まで静かに退出してください。それでは、解散の指示を出すまで静かにお待ちください。